
A PERMANENT CLAUDE PROJECTS SETUP · 2026

The Carousel Engine

Set this up once inside a Claude Project. From then on, drop in a topic and get a complete, ready-to-post carousel — hook, slides, content, examples, CTA — every time.

1

setup, done once,
works every time after

60

seconds is roughly what a
topic-to-carousel run takes

Pro

plan or higher needed —
Section 01 explains why

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One setup, not one prompt

Most people use Claude the same way every time: open a new chat, explain what they want, explain their brand, explain the format, then finally get to the actual topic. Claude Projects removes the first three steps permanently. Set the instructions once, and every new chat inside that project already knows all of it — you only ever type the topic.

That's the entire mechanism behind "60 seconds." It was never a faster model or a cleverer prompt. It's that the explaining only happens once.

WHAT THIS DOCUMENT IS

The exact project instructions to paste in, the correct place to put your brand details so they persist properly, and the difference between the two (which most people setting this up for the first time get backwards).

One thing to check before you start

Claude Projects requires at least the Pro plan — it is not available on the Free plan. Pro also includes Claude Code, unlimited projects, and access to more models, so if you're already considering an upgrade, this isn't the only thing it unlocks.

Verified against Claude's official pricing page, August 2026. Plans and what's included in each change — check claude.ai/pricing for the current lineup before assuming this section is still accurate.

Setting up the project

- 01** Go to claude.ai and click Projects in the sidebar, then New project.
- 02** Name it something you'll recognise in six months — "Carousel Engine — [your brand]" beats "Content".
- 03** Open Project instructions (sometimes called Custom instructions) and paste the full prompt from Section 02.
- 04** Open the Project knowledge / Files section and upload a short brand brief — see Section 03 for exactly what to put in it.
- 05** Start a new chat inside the project and type only a topic. That's the whole daily workflow from here on.

The one mechanic worth understanding

Project instructions and project knowledge files both apply automatically to every new chat you start inside the project. What does not carry over automatically is the content of previous chats — a carousel you generated on Monday isn't visible to Wednesday's new chat unless you save something about it into the knowledge files. This is why your brand brief belongs in Project knowledge, not just typed into your first chat and forgotten.

Instructions = the rules Claude always follows here. Knowledge = the reference material Claude can always see here. Chat history = not shared between chats unless you put it in one of the first two.

The project instructions

Paste this whole block into Project instructions. Shown here as two parts for page space — in the actual field it's one continuous block of text with no break.

PROJECT INSTRUCTIONS -- PART 1 of 2

You are a carousel content system. Every message you receive in this project is a topic. Your only job is turning that topic into a complete, ready-to-post Instagram carousel - never ask what format to use, always produce the full carousel directly.

Before writing, check the project's knowledge files for a brand brief (voice, niche, audience, point of view). If none exists yet, ask for it once, briefly, then proceed.

Output structure
Produce 8-10 slides:

SLIDE 1 - HOOK

Under 8 words. Must work as a standalone image in the feed - no 'swipe to learn more', earn the swipe. State a specific claim, number, or contrarian point - never a vague topic label.

SLIDE 2 - THE PROBLEM

Name the problem sharply enough the reader feels seen. This slide must survive being seen FIRST, since the algorithm can resurface a carousel starting from slide 2, not always slide 1.

SLIDES 3 to N-2 - THE CONTENT

One idea per slide, each independently useful - a reader who only screenshots one slide should still get real value. Use a real example or number on at least half of these slides. Never fill a slide with theory alone.

SLIDE N-1 - THE SUMMARY

Recap the core idea in a form worth saving. This is the slide people screenshot and send to a friend - write it for that.

SLIDE N - CTA

One action only. Match the CTA to the topic - don't default to 'follow for more' when the content earned something more specific.

Project instructions, part 2

PROJECT INSTRUCTIONS

For every slide, give me

- The headline (max 8 words)
- The body text (max 25 words)
- A one-line visual note (what should be on screen - photo, illustration, data point, quote treatment)

Also always include

- 3 alternative slide-1 headlines, in case the first doesn't land
- A caption (120-180 words) that extends the carousel rather than repeating it, ending in one specific call to action
- 5 hashtags maximum

Rules

- Match the tone, language and point of view in the brand brief exactly. If Hinglish is specified, write Hinglish - not English with a Hindi phrase dropped in.
- Never invent a statistic, result, or claim not in the brand brief or supplied by me in the topic message. Mark anything that needs a real number as [ADD REAL NUMBER].
- No slide may be a content-free transition.
- Prioritise one thing the reader can actually apply today over general theory, on every content slide.
- If the topic is too broad for one carousel, narrow it yourself and tell me what you narrowed it to and why, rather than producing something shallow that tries to cover everything.

The brand brief (upload this as a file)

Save this as a short text or PDF file and upload it to Project knowledge — not just pasted into a chat message. This is what makes every carousel sound like you without retyping your voice each time.

BRAND-BRIEF.md

BRAND BRIEF

Niche: [what you post about, one line]
Audience: [who specifically - role, stage, situation]
Tone: [e.g. Hinglish, direct, no-hype, occasionally contrarian]
My point of view: [the opinion you want to be known for -
what you believe that most accounts in your
niche do not say]
Proof I can reference: [real numbers, client results, personal
experience - only things that are true]
What I will NOT post: [off-limits topics, claims, or formats]
Typical CTA: [what you usually want people to do - follow,
comment a keyword, visit a link, DM you]

Why this file matters more than the prompt itself

The project instructions in Section 02 are generic on purpose — they work for any account. This file is what's actually yours. Two people using the identical Section 02 prompt with two different brand briefs will get two completely different carousels from the same topic, which is exactly the point.

SECTION 04

Using it day to day

Once setup is done, this is genuinely the entire workflow.

You do	Claude does
Start a new chat inside the project	Loads your project instructions and brand brief automatically
Type a topic — even just a phrase	Narrows it if too broad, tells you what it narrowed to
Wait	Produces all 8-10 slides, 3 alt headlines, a caption, and hashtags
Review against Section 06's checklist	Nothing — this step is yours
Copy content into Canva, Figma, or your design tool of choice	Nothing — Claude writes the content, not the visual file itself

A genuinely minimal topic message

EXAMPLE TOPIC MESSAGE — THAT'S THE WHOLE MESSAGE

why most people fail at consistency, not content quality

A more directive one, when you already know the angle

EXAMPLE TOPIC MESSAGE — MORE SPECIFIC

Topic: why most people fail at consistency, not content quality.
Angle: tie it to having a repeatable system instead of relying on motivation. Reference this exact Carousel Engine as the example if it fits naturally.

What the output looks like

A compressed sample — real output runs to all 8-10 slides plus caption and hashtags.

SLIDE 1 - HOOK

Headline: "Consistency isn't a personality trait"

Visual: bold type, high contrast, no photo

SLIDE 2 - THE PROBLEM

Headline: "You don't lack discipline"

Body: You lack a system that works when motivation doesn't show up - which is every day, eventually.

Visual: simple two-column contrast graphic

SLIDE 3 - CONTENT

Headline: "Decide once, not daily"

Body: A content system removes the decision, not the discipline. [ADD REAL NUMBER: your own weekly output before/after]

Visual: before/after style split

Notice the [ADD REAL NUMBER] marker on slide 3 — the instructions in Section 02 are built to flag exactly this instead of inventing a statistic. Fill it in with something true before posting, or cut the line.

Before you post it

Thirty seconds against this list, every time — this is the human step the system doesn't do for you.

- ☐ Slide 1 works as a standalone image — would it stop a scroll with zero context?
- ☐ Slide 2 also works if someone sees it first — does it still make sense out of order?
- ☐ Every [ADD REAL NUMBER] or placeholder has been filled with something true, or removed
- ☐ At least half the content slides have a specific example or number, not just a claim
- ☐ The tone actually sounds like you, not a generic version of your niche
- ☐ The summary slide is genuinely worth screenshotting on its own
- ☐ The CTA matches what this specific carousel earned, not a default "follow for more"
- ☐ Nothing in here would need a disclaimer or a correction next week

If it fails more than one of these

Reply in the same chat rather than starting over: "slide 4 is generic, make it more specific to [your actual example]" or "the hook is too vague, give me 5 sharper alternatives." Claude still has full context from your project instructions and the conversation so far — iterating is faster than a fresh topic message.

Making it genuinely yours

The Section 02 prompt is a strong default. These are the places worth adjusting once you've run it a dozen times and know what you'd change.

- Slide count. 8-10 is a broad-audience default. Dense, expert-audience content can work well at 6; a genuine step-by-step guide can justify 12. Edit the instruction directly.
- The CTA rule. If you run one consistent CTA (a keyword comment, a link in bio), hard-code it into the instructions instead of leaving it to Claude's judgement each time.
- Visual notes detail. If you or a designer wants more specific direction (exact colors, a named template), add that level of detail to the visual-note instruction.
- A second project for a second brand. Don't overload one project with two brand briefs — clone the whole setup into a new project instead, one per brand or client.

Treat the Section 02 prompt as a first draft of a system, not a finished one. The version you're using in month three should be visibly stricter than the one you started with — every awkward output you had to fix by hand is a rule worth adding permanently.

Common pitfalls

- Brand brief pasted into a chat instead of uploaded as a knowledge file. It'll work for that one chat and vanish for the next — this is the single most common setup mistake.
- Topics that are really three topics. "Marketing and sales and mindset" produces a shallow carousel trying to cover all three. One topic per run.
- Never editing the instructions after launch. The prompt in Section 02 is a strong start, not a finished system — see Section 07.
- Posting without the Section 06 check. The placeholder-marking rule only helps if you actually look for the placeholders before publishing.
- One project for every brand. Mixed brand briefs produce carousels that sound like neither — clone the project per brand instead.

Offering this as a service

A working Carousel Engine, tuned per client, is a fast and genuinely valuable thing to set up for someone else.

- 01** Interview the client for the brand brief properly — the quality gap between a rushed brief and a real one shows up in every single carousel afterward.
- 02** Deliver the project already set up, not just the prompt as a text file. Log into their account, or walk them through Section 01 live — the setup is most of the value.
- 03** Run 3-5 test topics together before handing it over, and tighten the instructions based on what needed fixing.
- 04** Price it as a system, not a prompt. A client who understands they're buying a permanent content engine values this very differently from someone who thinks they're buying one clever message.

Sources & notes

Checked August 2026, directly against Claude's official pricing page and current product documentation.

What the guide says	Basis
Claude Projects requires the Pro plan or higher; not included on Free	claude.com/pricing — official plan comparison and FAQ, verified directly
Pro also includes Claude Code, Claude Cowork, Claude Design, unlimited projects, and access to more models	claude.com/pricing , official feature list
Project instructions and project knowledge files apply automatically to every new chat in a project; chat history itself is not automatically shared between chats	Cross-checked across multiple independent 2026 Claude Projects guides
A carousel can be resurfaced by the algorithm starting from a slide other than the first	Adam Mosseri, Head of Instagram, on carousel performance

Pricing and plan features are subject to change at Anthropic's discretion — verify current plan details at claude.ai/pricing before this section is the basis of a purchasing decision.

THAT'S THE ENGINE

Explain it once. Use it forever.

Most people rebuild their brief in their head every time they open a new chat, then wonder why content feels slower than it should. The fix was never a better prompt in the moment — it was moving the explanation somewhere permanent, once.

Set up the project today. Run your first real topic through it before you close this document.

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If you tighten Section 02 into something sharper, send it over — the best version of this system has always come from someone who actually ran it a hundred times.

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